to recapture the lost territory, but Pakistani troops held on to the area. The ceasefire denied the Indians another opportunity to beat back the Pakistanis.

XI Corps' northern flank was protected by 29 Infantry Brigade Group, which captured Dera Baba Nanak on 7 September. XI Corps generally succeeded in its mission to capture areas east of Ichhogil Canal except in the Khem Karan sector, where Pakistani forces remained in control of a small enclave. After the launch of I Corps' counter-offensive in the Sialkot sector, however, Pakistan was forced to divert 3 Armoured Brigade from the Khem Karan sector to the Sialkot sector to stabilize the situation there.

I Corps' counter-offensive

On 8 September, the Indian Army's recently raised I Corps (GOC Major General Patrick Oswald Dunn) launched an attack in the Sialkot sector as part of India's overall strategy to relieve pressure in the Chhamb sector and to degrade Pakistan's fighting potential. Dunn's corps was tasked with securing the Bhagowal–Phillora–Chawinda–Crossroads (Badiana) area, with a view to advancing towards the Marala–Ravi Link Canal and eventually to the line of Dhalliwali–Wuhilam–Daska–Mandhali. While 26 Infantry Division carried out a diversionary move in the north towards Sialkot, 6 Mountain Division attacked Pakistani forces in the Charwa–Maharajake area and captured the locality after some fighting; 14 Infantry Division established a bridgehead in the Ikhnal area further to the east, which set the stage for the advance of India's 1 Armoured Division. Dunn's command was opposed by Pakistan's I Corps, composed of 6 Armoured Division and 15 Infantry Division.

The Indian I Corps offensive achieved complete surprise, but after initial success its operations came to a near-standstill with no major operational activity on 9 and 10 September. Thereafter, 1 Armoured Division commenced its attack on Phillora at first light on 10 September. In a well-coordinated operation involving armour, lorried infantry and artillery, 1 Armoured Brigade operating on both flanks of Phillora drew away the Pakistani armour while 43 Lorried Infantry Brigade captured the settlement in a spirited action. The Pakistan Army lost roughly 60 tanks in this battle and Indian forces captured 388 square kilometres in the sector.